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data.gov.in
Open Government Data Platform India
NDSAP
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CONTROLLED VOCABULARY
GODL
CENTRAL GOVERNMENT
STATE GOVERNMENTS
OGD PLATFORM
VISUALIZATION ENGINE
SAAS INSTANCES
OPEN GOVERNMENT DATA
EVENTS
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INDUSTRY
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ACCOUNTABILITY
INNOVATION
TRANSPARENCY
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OPEN GOVERNANCE
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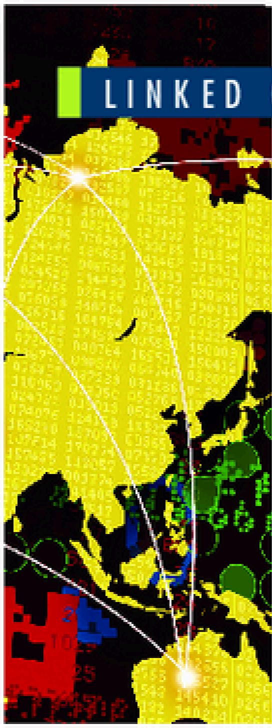

Linked Open Government Data: Lessons from Data.gov.uk

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A project to extract value from open government data contributes to the population of the linked data Web with high-value data of good provenance.

Services require data. In a top-down political culture where the state is the service provider of first resort, the state becomes a powerful data monopoly, able to structure and homogenize the interactions between itself and its citizens. Such one-sided interactions are expensive and unresponsive to citizens' needs. Even when governments have exposed service provision to market disciplines, they haven't succeeded in presenting data to citizens in innovative ways to create new value streams. Privatized service providers have preserved monopolies of service design and provision.

As technology has increased the power of data by facilitating linking and sharing, and political thinkers have embraced transparency and citizens' right to data, this top-down culture is being challenged. Many governments now release large quantities of data into the public domain, often free of charge and without administrative overhead. This allows citizen-centered service delivery and design and improves accountability of public services, leading to better public-service outcomes.

In the United Kingdom, transparency is focused on Data.gov.uk, the public data catalogue that points to thousands of datasets downloadable under a permissive open government license. The datasets are often in comma-separated value (CSV) format or spreadsheets, but there is potential for increasing their utility by linking them using structured machine-processable formats. Resource Description Framework (RDF) is the format most integrated into current thinking about future generations of the Web, as its use of URIs allows data to be identified by reference and linked with other relevant data by subject, predicate, or object. The use of Semantic Web standards in open government data (OGD) was pioneered by Advanced Knowledge Technologies (AKT) in a precursor to the work described here, and was reported to the UK Parliament in 2007.[1]

We refer to this vision as the linked-data Web (LDW). The LDW is already well populated through initiatives such as DBpedia, the DBLP Computer Science Bibliography, the *London Gazette*, the *New York Times*, and the Comprehensive Knowledge Archive Network (CKAN). The formalisms and infrastructure are appearing according

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